

Board 1

West Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 9 3
♥ 10 5 4
♦ K J 10
♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7
♥ A Q 9 8 6 2
♦ Q 7
♣ 7 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 5 4 2
♥ J
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A K J
♥ K 7 3
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ 8 6 4

West	North	East	South
1NT	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North rectified.			

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♣J. West wins ♣A K Q then switches to a trump.

West takes ♣A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

West opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and East has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with West and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already

You plan to squeeze West by running the long ♥s in your hand, but the problem is that the ♦Q is not a Threat card yet. To make it a Threat you need to unblock dummy's ♦A. So play the ♦A, then pull trumps with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to West.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. West is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

[showcards N:SA,SK,SJ,D6 E:SQ,ST,S9,DK S:S8,S7,H6,DQ W:S6,S5,D9,D8]

West is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

West can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not West.

If you discard the ♦6 West will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, West will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 2

♥ 9 3

♦ A K 8 6

♣ K Q 10 6 5

♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ 10 8 6 2

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ -



♠ Q 7

♥ A 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ A J 9 7 3 2

♠ J 10 6 5

♥ K Q J 7 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 4

West

North

East

South

2 ♦

Pass

3 ♣

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

6 ♣

All Pass

6 ♣ by East

Unblocking the ♠ A to create a Threat out of your ♠ Q is the Vienna Coup.

As you see, North was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣ 7 and discard dummy's ♠ 2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠ K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠ Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6 ♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥ K.

East is to play 6 ♣. South leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠ K and that a squeeze will be possible.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you should rectify the count, so you win the first trick, pull trumps in two rounds, then give up a ♥ trick.

South takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦ 9 which you win with your ♦ Q.

You now make the key play of taking dummy's ♠ A before running three rounds of ♣ s.

[showcards N:S2,DA,DK,D8 E:SK,DJ,DT,D7 S:SQ,D5,D4,C7 W:SJ,ST,HQ,D2]